

FRANKLY SPEAKING...

CONSUMER EDITION | OCTOBER 2026

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Get ready today. Get home tomorrow.

Real talk on the market, your options, and preparing for your next move.



Market Snapshot

SEPTEMBER 2026 | MSA REPORT

Nashville-Davidson
Murfreesboro-Franklin MSA

\$533,995

Median asking price

62 days

Median days on market

12,150

Active listings (excludes pending)

What it means for buyers

September brought more choice: inventory rose 12% year over year, while median asking prices fell 1%. Price reductions appeared on 22.5% of listings.

That may give buyers room to compare homes and discuss price or closing-cost concessions. Opportunities vary by neighborhood and property. Start with a comfortable payment and a financing plan.

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, September 2026. [1] MSA figures include single-family homes and condos/townhomes.

Program Spotlight

JMAC FHA Combo

This option pairs an FHA first mortgage with down payment assistance through a second mortgage.

- **Assistance:** 3.5% or 5% of the lower of price or appraised value.
- **Credit:** 600 with automated approval; 620 for manual underwriting.
- **Financing:** 96.5% first-mortgage LTV; up to 100% or 101.5% combined LTV, based on the option.
- **Eligibility:** No income cap or first-time buyer requirement. Homebuyer education required.

Know how repayment works

Repayable options: 10-year second mortgage with monthly payments; rate is 2 percentage points above the first mortgage.

Forgivable 3.5% option: no interest or monthly payments; forgiveness after three years requires meeting its conditions. Earlier first-mortgage payoff may require repayment.

JMAC guidelines, 9/4/2026. Approval and conditions apply. Other purchase costs may remain.

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THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: CREDIT + HOMEBUYING PREPARATION

Current Rates

Five examples. One starting score.

These Conventional, FHA, USDA, and VA examples use a 680 credit score. Your actual pricing depends on the program and your financial picture.

Pricing supplied October 2, 2026 at 4:05 p.m. Central. Subject to change.

Program / Down	Rate	APR	Lender Credit
Conventional 20%	7.250%	7.280%	\$694
Conventional 5%	7.250%	8.005%	\$2,250
FHA 3.5%	6.375%	7.1222%	\$1,465
USDA 0%	6.375%	6.824%	\$495
VA 0%	6.375%	6.610%	\$173

*"Whatever this week took from you,
may the weekend give it back."*

Author unknown

Quote assumptions: \$400,000 purchase price; 680 credit score; 30-year fixed; single-family home; primary residence; 30-day lock. Down payments shown above. Rates may change; examples are not a commitment to lend.

Mortgage Tips

Credit first. Keys later. Here's where to begin.

1. Know what's on your reports.

Review your credit reports at AnnualCreditReport.com. Check accounts, balances, and payment history. Dispute inaccurate information through the proper process. Checking your own credit does not lower your scores. [2]

2. Protect your payment history.

Set reminders or automatic payments and keep enough funds available. Paying on time consistently is a major part of building stronger credit. [3]

3. Make a manageable paydown plan.

Using less of your available credit can help your scores. You do not need to carry a balance or pay interest to build credit. Avoid promising yourself a specific point increase. [3]

4. Plan for the whole purchase.

Track your spending and set a comfortable housing budget. Build savings for closing costs, moving, repairs, and a cushion after closing. Discuss new debt before adding it as your purchase gets closer. [2, 4]

YOUR MOVE THIS MONTH

Review your reports. List your monthly debts. Pick a savings goal you can sustain.

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YOUR QUESTIONS, ANSWERED | YOUR NEXT STEP, MADE CLEAR

Frequently Asked Questions

1. Should I talk with Frank if I'm six months away?

Yes. We can discuss your timeline, budget, and preparation before you're ready to apply.

2. Does checking my own credit lower my score?

No. Checking your own reports or scores does not hurt your scores. [2]

3. Is my credit app score my mortgage score?

It may differ. Scores vary by model, reporting source, and lending product. [5]

4. Do I need perfect credit to start planning?

No. Start where you are. Loan requirements vary; an early conversation helps identify what needs attention.

5. Should I close cards I don't use?

Be cautious. Closing a card can reduce available credit and affect your scores. Review the potential effect first. [3]

6. Do I have to save 20% down?

Not necessarily. Some programs offer lower down payments or no down payment for eligible borrowers. [4]

7. How long does improving credit take?

There's no guaranteed timetable or point increase. Focus on consistent habits and resolving inaccurate information.

8. What should I bring to our first conversation?

Your timeline, comfortable payment, approximate savings, monthly debts, and questions. We'll discuss documents next.

Thinking about buying this year or next?

Let's put a plan behind it.

Call or text **615.364.5700** and say **"PLAN."**

We'll talk about where you are today and what comes next.

Clear To Close Starts Here.

[MORTGAGE PROCESS →](#)

[HOMEBUYER GUIDE →](#)

[HOMES OF THE WEEK →](#)

[SCHEDULE WITH FRANK →](#)

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Sources: [1] Realtor.com Economic Research, September 2026 metro data [2] CFPB: Get your money situation in order

[3] CFPB: Rebuild credit [4] CFPB: Ready to buy a home? [5] CFPB: Understand your credit score